

The Arnolfini Marriage, painted by Jan van Eyck in 1434



Looking for clues

This painting records a couple's marriage. But if you look closely you will see it is much more than just a wedding picture.

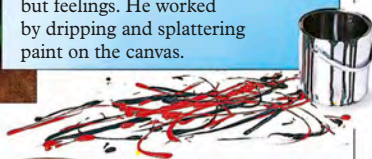
One candle is left to burn, even though it is daylight, to show that the couple will always love each other.

Like the merchant, his wife is wearing expensive clothes. It was the fashion to hold your skirts this way.



Action painting

In this painting, modern American artist Jackson Pollock was not trying to show objects or people, but feelings. He worked by dripping and splattering paint on the canvas.



Son of Man



by René Magritte

Marilyn Monroe



by Andy Warhol



The light shines on the couple's hands, and the artist has shown every tiny line.

Painting portraits

For thousands of years artists have enjoyed painting pictures of people. Not all of them painted the person true to life—there are many different styles of painting.